No. 1 HINDU COLLEGE, DELHI

Chemistry of Success

THE PANDEMIC SQUEEZE SPURS INNOVATION AND ENTREPRENEURSHIP, WITH A DIGITAL TWIST

By Sonali Acharjee

Across the world, Covid-19 has upended the way things are done. Colleges, like all other organisations, have had to adapt. This has led to some novel stories: for example, last year, Hindu College patented a machine for virus disinfection developed by students from its science department. Explaining the institution's push for innovation and entrepreneurship, Anju Srivastava, principal of Hindu, says: "We wanted to keep students engaged by giving them opportunities they wouldn't get in the regular curriculum."

Last year, the college administration could see the toll the pandemic was taking via the enforced isolation and the lack of extra-curricular/social activity. The lack of in-person meeting places as a result of Covid restrictions meant alternative venues had to be found, with much of the activity shifting online. To combat social isolation, the administration set up a series of after-class lectures and workshops on various topics outside the official curriculum. These ranged from biochemistry and toxicology to pest control, and the administration says it looked for ways to present the material in en-



EYES ON THE PRIZE
Students in a chemistry lab at Hindu College, New Delhi